

What is theory?

The word 'theory' derives from the Greek 'theorein', which means 'to look at'.

The theory was first floated in the 1950s by Professor Homer Dubs of Oxford University.

An idea or set of ideas that is intended to explain facts or events

An idea that is suggested or presented as possibly true but that is not known or proven to be true

A scientific theory is not the end result of the scientific method; theories can be proven or rejected, just like hypotheses

Difference between Social and Sociological theory

Social Theory

Social theory focuses on commentary and critique of modern society rather than explanation, and its goals are intensively political.

Social theories are analytical frameworks, or paradigms, that are used to study and interpret social phenomena.

Sociological theory

Sociological theory is centered on the attempt to understand the society.

A sociological theory is a supposition that intends to consider, analyze, and/or explain objects of social reality from a sociological perspective, drawing connections between individual concepts in order to organize and substantiate sociological knowledge.

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Biography of Auguste Comte

He was Born in January
19, 1798 in
Montpellier, France

He Died in Sep 5, 1857
(at age 59)
Paris, France

Auguste Comte was a famous French philosopher who is best known as the founder of discipline of sociology

In some cases, he is regarded as the first philosopher of the science, too.

He is known as the father of Sociology

Auguste Comte was the first to develop the concept of Sociology

He even developed the famous Positive Philosophy in a great attempt to remedy the social malaise of French Revolution.

He talked about Positivism, or the idea that the truth only comes from scientific knowledge

His Major publications are

The Course of Positive Philosophy

A general view of positivism

Discourse on Positive spirit

Releigion of humanity

Law Of Three Stages

The law of three stages is an idea developed by Auguste Comte in his work The Course in Positive Philosophy

Comte believed that sociology could identify three major stages to the development of global society.

Comte saw his law of three stages as the start of the scientific field of sociology as a positive science.

Comte's law of three stages has a strong mentalist or idealistic bias. He co-related each mental age of mankind with its characteristic accompanying social organisation and type of political dominance.

Law of three stages appeared in, the year 1822 in his book Positive Philosophy.

These three stages are

Theological stage

Metaphysical stage

The positive Stage

Theological stage

Theological or Fictitious Stage is very old and most primitive stage of interpreting science and any social phenomenon.

In primitive societies individuals believed that each social phenomenon and events are considered to be the will of God.

During the earlier stages, people believed that all the phenomena of nature are the creation of the divine or supernatural.

Human beings are infused with emotions, sentiments and feeling which lead them to believe that, behind occurrence of every event there is supernatural power.

Theological stage

Theological stage is further divided into three stages

- 1) Fetishism
- 2) Polytheism
- 3) Monotheism

Fetishism

The primary stage of theology is fetishism.

In this stage people believed that, spirits are embodied by nature like, trees, stones and wood, which is known as animism.

People used to preach them and explain and interpret everything according to their religious belief.

Theological stage

Polytheism

In this stage primitive people believe in multiple God.

They believed that natural forces are controlled by Multiple Gods

For Example

- God of Rain
- God of fire
- God of air

Monotheism

In this stage people believe in one God and believed to be the creator of world and supreme power.

Nothing can happen in this world without the will of God.

- Individuals in theological stage believe that, all the natural and social events are the work of supreme and supernatural power.

Metaphysical or Abstract Stage

People in metaphysical stage believe in God, however, they do not explain, everything which happens in the society is due to the will of God.

However, Most of the problems take place due to the inadequacy of humans.

To make sense of the world; religious and scientific view co-exists in metaphysical stage

This stage is also called, “transitional stage” because it progresses from absolute imagination to rationality.

Social phenomena in metaphysical stage is explain through amalgamation of religious belief and rationality.

For example

if someone is sick they may associate sickness with germs which is rational however, they might use the spiritual ritual to cure the disease.

Positive or Scientific Stage

Each social phenomenon in this stage is explained by the scientific findings and empirical research.

All phenomena are explained by the people rationally and scientifically

According to Comte, positivism is absolutely intellectual way to determine social phenomenon, there is no place for supernatural power in it.

In this stage religion became less predominant and scientific methods become more predominant in obtaining knowledge.

For example

if someone is sick it not is interpreted and explained as, the will of God or caused due to some supernatural power or the result of wrong doing of individual which make the God angry and unleashed his wrath upon him in the form of sickness , that the illness is caused by germs.